nanuq

USER MANUAL

# Everything you can do with Nanuq

Your Jellyfin music, with a polar bear that dances with you. A step-by-step guide, with pictures of the app.





Version 1.44.4 · November 8, 2026 · English · Free software (GPL-3.0-or-later)



# Contents

Start wherever you like: each chapter stands on its own.


1 **Meet Nanuq** 4
A music player for your Jellyfin server, with a polar bear that dances with you.

2 **Installing** 5
Pick your platform: the same Nanuq on all of them.

3 **Getting started** 6
Connect Nanuq to your server.

4 **The home screen** 8
Your mixes, the DJ and what's new, at a glance.

5 **Playing music** 10
The player, the queue and everything you can do with a song.

6 **Lyrics** 12
Lyrics that follow the song, and how to get them.

7 **Search (also by lyrics)** 14
Find a song even if you only remember a bit of the lyrics.

8 **Your library** 15
Albums, artists, genres, playlists, favorites and folders.

9 **DJ Nanuq** 17
Your music presented like on the radio, without AI.

10 **Your week and Your year** 18
What you listened to, in a video to share.

11 **Party** 19
Your computer plays the music; your friends pick it from their phones.

12 **My devices** 21
One Nanuq plays; the others control it.

13 **On the phone** 22
Music in your pocket, with or without data.

14 **Request a song** 23
Missing a song? Request it.

15 **Settings** 24
Everything you can adjust, in one place.

16 **Themes** 26
18 themes, 18 Nanuqs.

17 **Privacy and security** 28
Your music, your data, your server.

18 **Troubleshooting** 29
When something doesn't go as expected.

01

# Meet Nanuq

A music player for your Jellyfin server, with a polar bear that dances with you.



Nanuq is an app to listen to the music you keep on your **Jellyfin** server. It works on Android, Linux, Windows and in the browser, in English or Spanish, with no ads or extra accounts.

Its mascot is **Nanuq**, a polar bear with headphones: it dances when each song starts, gets sad for a moment when you pause, fills the gaps on the home screen with scenes and gets visits from the Nanuqs of other themes. Each of the 18 themes gives it a different costume.

## What you can do

- **Listen to your library**: albums (built from your songs' tags), artists, genres, playlists, favorites and folders.
- **Synced lyrics** that move with the song, and find, paste or sync them by hand.
- **DJ Nanuq**: an endless session in rounds, presented by Nanuq, that explores your library.
- **Party**: your computer opens a room and your friends send songs from their phones.
- **My devices**: control one Nanuq from another or send the music from one to another.
- **Your week and Your year with Nanuq**: your recaps on video.
- On the phone: **downloads** to listen without data and **what's next saved ahead of time**.

## What you need

- A **Jellyfin** server with your music (10.9 or newer for lyrics; everything else works from 10.8).
- Your Jellyfin username and password.
- Optional: the **Playback Reporting** plugin (exact recaps) and **SomeDL** (requesting songs).



**Nanuq's tip**

Don't have a server yet? Tap **Try demo mode** on the login screen: Nanuq comes with a sample library with music it made itself.

# 02 Installing

Pick your platform: the same Nanuq on all of them.



Download the latest version from the project's **Releases** page.

| Platform | File | How to install |
|---|---|---|
| Android 7+ | `nanuq-<version>-release.apk` | Open it on the phone and allow installing apps from that source. |
| Windows | `nanuq-<version>-setup.exe` | Open it and follow the installer. If Windows says "Windows protected your PC", tap **More info** → **Run anyway** (it isn't signed yet). |
| Linux (Flatpak) | `nanuq-<version>.flatpak` | `flatpak install nanuq-<version>.flatpak` |
| Linux (AppImage) | `nanuq-<version>-x86_64.AppImage` | `chmod +x` and open it. |
| Fedora / Nobara | `nanuq-<version>-x86_64.rpm` | `sudo dnf install ./nanuq-…rpm` |
| Browser | `web/` folder | Host it on a web server over https (see `web/LEEME.en.md`). |

## Updating

Install the new version over the old one: your data is kept. On Flatpak, install the new file from the terminal with the same command.

## Verifying the APK

All official APKs are signed with the same certificate. Check its SHA-256 fingerprint with `apksigner verify --print-certs`; it must be:

```
9A:B9:59:A9:62:BD:DF:AA:1E:D3:0F:3B:2D:94:8D:55:F8:CB:54:41:B4:74:02:30:1E:EB:E7:9D:5A:74:D3:BD
```



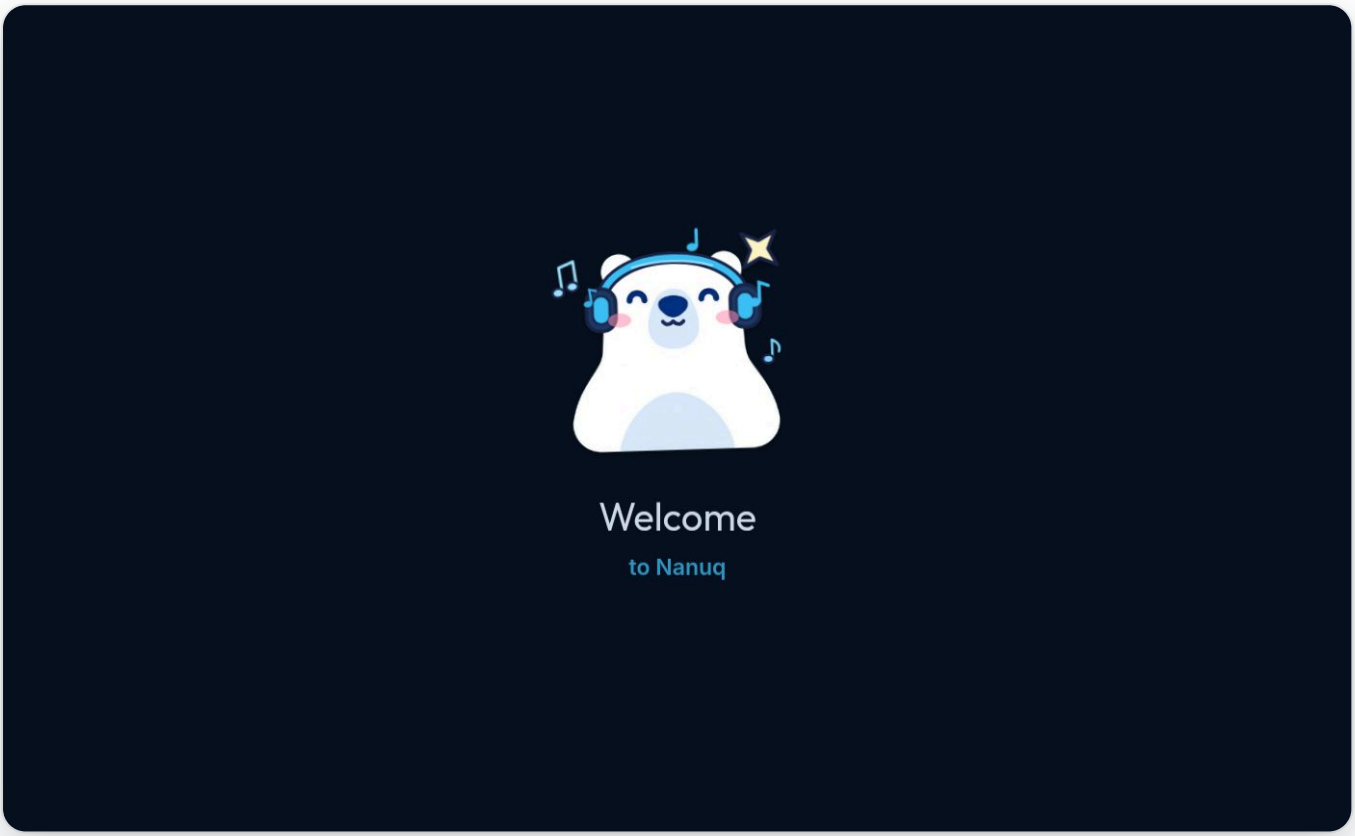
**Heads-up**

If the fingerprint doesn't match, don't install it: it isn't an official Nanuq.

# 03 Getting started

Connect Nanuq to your server.






The login screen.

1. Type your server address: a name (`music.example.com`), an IPv4 (`192.168.1.20`) or an IPv6 (`[2001:db8::10]`). If you don't add a port, Nanuq uses Jellyfin's (8096). The final address shows below.
2. In the apps, tap **Find servers on my network** to find your Jellyfin automatically. Servers you used before show up under **Recent servers**, with how long they take to answer.
3. Tap **Connect**, type your username and password and tap **Log in**.

Nanuq greets you with its welcome screen and takes you **Home**. Your session is saved **encrypted** on the device: next time you go straight in.



**Heads-up**

If the server is on the internet over `http://`, Nanuq warns you: your password would travel unprotected. Use `https://` or a VPN.

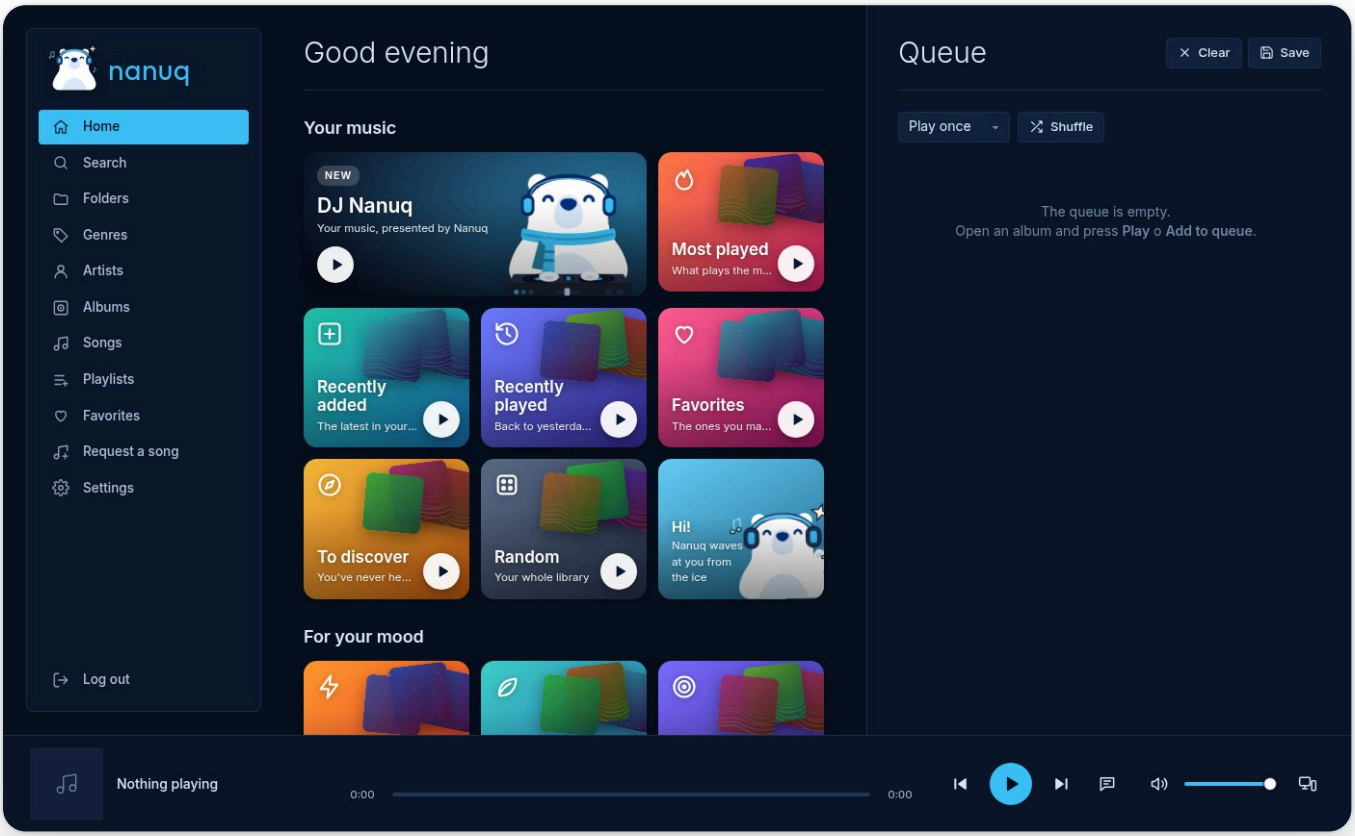
## Language

Nanuq speaks English and Spanish. In **Settings** → **Language** you pick one. On Android, until you choose, it uses the phone's language (and if it's neither, English). When you change it, the app reopens in that language and the music stays paused at the same second.

# 04 The home screen

Your mixes, the DJ and what's new, at a glance.






Home on the computer, with the queue on the right.

- **Your music**: the **DJ Nanuq** card and automatic mixes: most played, recently added, recently played, favorites, to discover and random. Tap one to see its songs or its ▶ button to play it right away.
- **For your mood**: energy, chill, focus, party, nostalgia and melancholy, built from your library's genres.
- **Recently added albums**.
- Gaps are filled with **Nanuq scenes** (nap, skating, fishing, aurora...). Tap them: Nanuq reacts. Sometimes a Nanuq from another theme drops by.

## Getting around

On the computer you use the **sidebar**; on the phone, the tabs at the bottom (Home, Songs, Search, Queue and **More**, where everything else is).

| Shortcut | What it does |
|---|---|
| Space | Play / pause |
| Shift + → / ← | Next / previous |

| Shortcut | What it does |
| --- | --- |
| / | Go to Search |
| Esc | Back (closes dialogs and the player) |
| F11 | Full screen (desktop) |

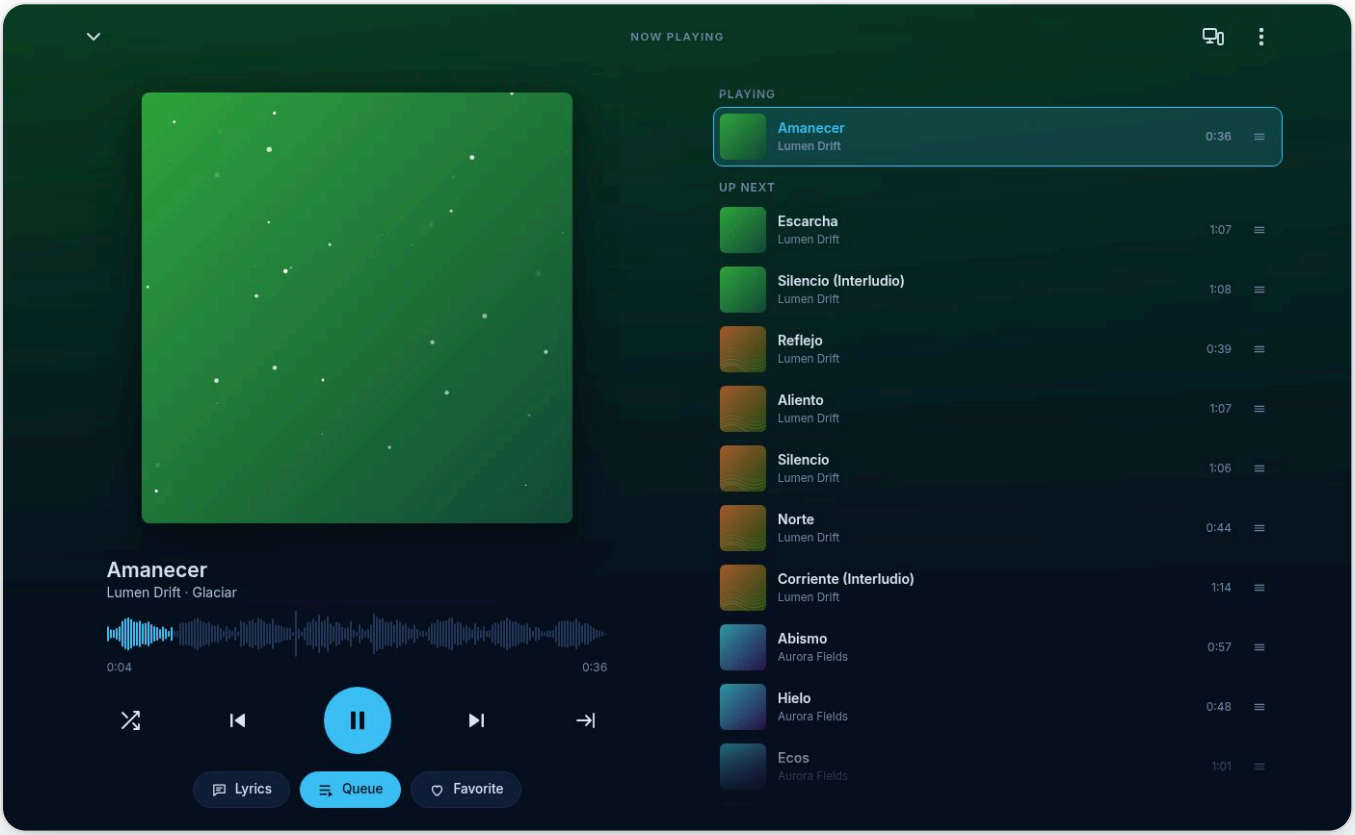
# 05 Playing music

The player, the queue and everything you can do with a song.



Tap any song to play it. The player shows up at the bottom; tap it to open the **full-screen player**, with the cover, the waveform (drag it to seek), the controls, **shuffle** and the **repeat** mode (play once, repeat all, repeat one).

## The queue




The Queue button swaps the cover for what's next.

- Tap a song in the queue to play it now.
- **Drag** by the handle (≡) to change the order; near the edge, the list scrolls on its own.
- Right-click (computer) or press and hold (phone): play now, play next, radio, playlist, favorite, go to album or artist, remove.
- **Save** turns the queue into a playlist in your Jellyfin.

## Song options

- **Start song radio**: similar songs by artist, album and genre.
- **Add to a playlist** (or create a new one).

- **Favorite ♥**: saved in Jellyfin and Nanuq checks it with the server.
- **Go to album / artist**.



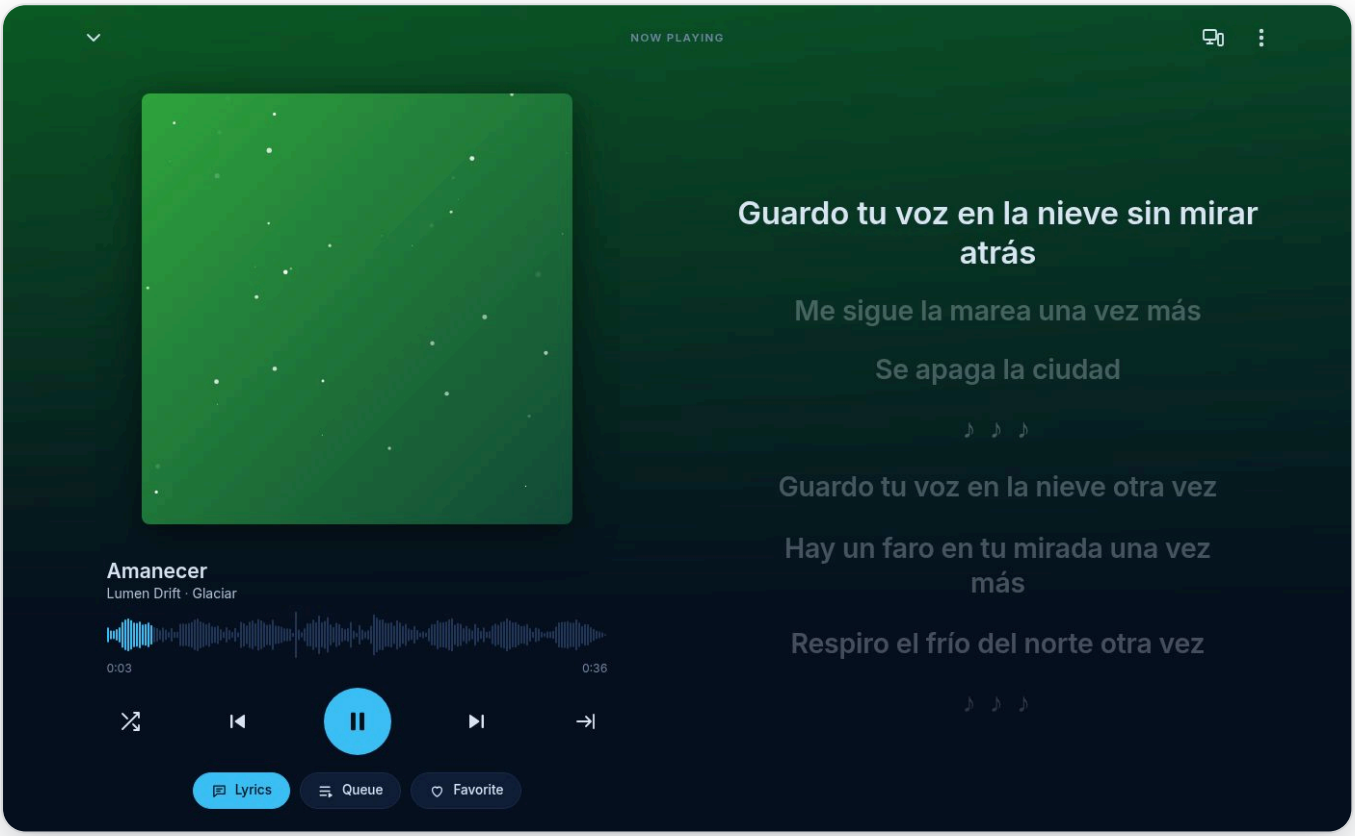
**Nanuq's tip**
When you pause, the music fades out, and when you resume it fades in. If you'd rather it stop instantly, turn off **Settings** → **Fade on pause**.

Nanuq remembers the song and the second you were at: if you close the app, when you come back tap ▶ and it continues where it was.

# 06 Lyrics

Lyrics that follow the song, and how to get them.





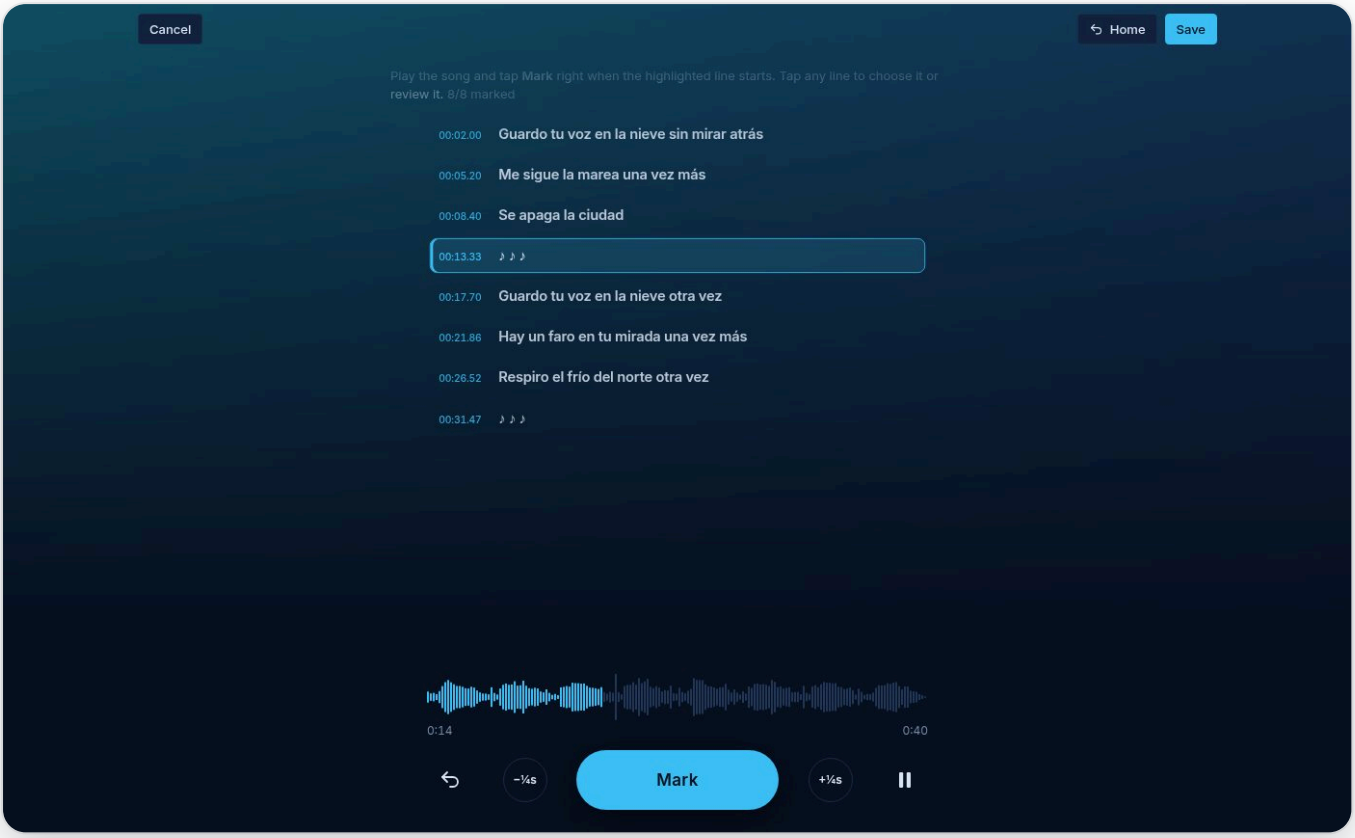

The playing line lights up; the others dim.

Tap **Lyrics** in the player. The playing line lights up and the lyrics move on their own; tap a line to jump to that moment. Jellyfin 10.9+ reads them from `.lrc` files next to your songs or from the **LrcLib** plugin.

## If there are no lyrics

- **Find lyrics**: Nanuq searches LrcLib and you pick a version.
- **Paste lyrics**: paste them yourself (better if they have `[00:12.34]` timestamps).

# Syncing by hand




The editor: tap Mark when each line starts.

1. Tap **Sync** (or ⋮ → Sync lyrics by hand).
2. Play the song and tap **Mark** right when the highlighted line starts (on a computer, Enter).
3. Fix it with ↶ (undo) and −¼s / +¼s.
4. Tap **Save**: Nanuq uploads an `.lrc` to your Jellyfin.



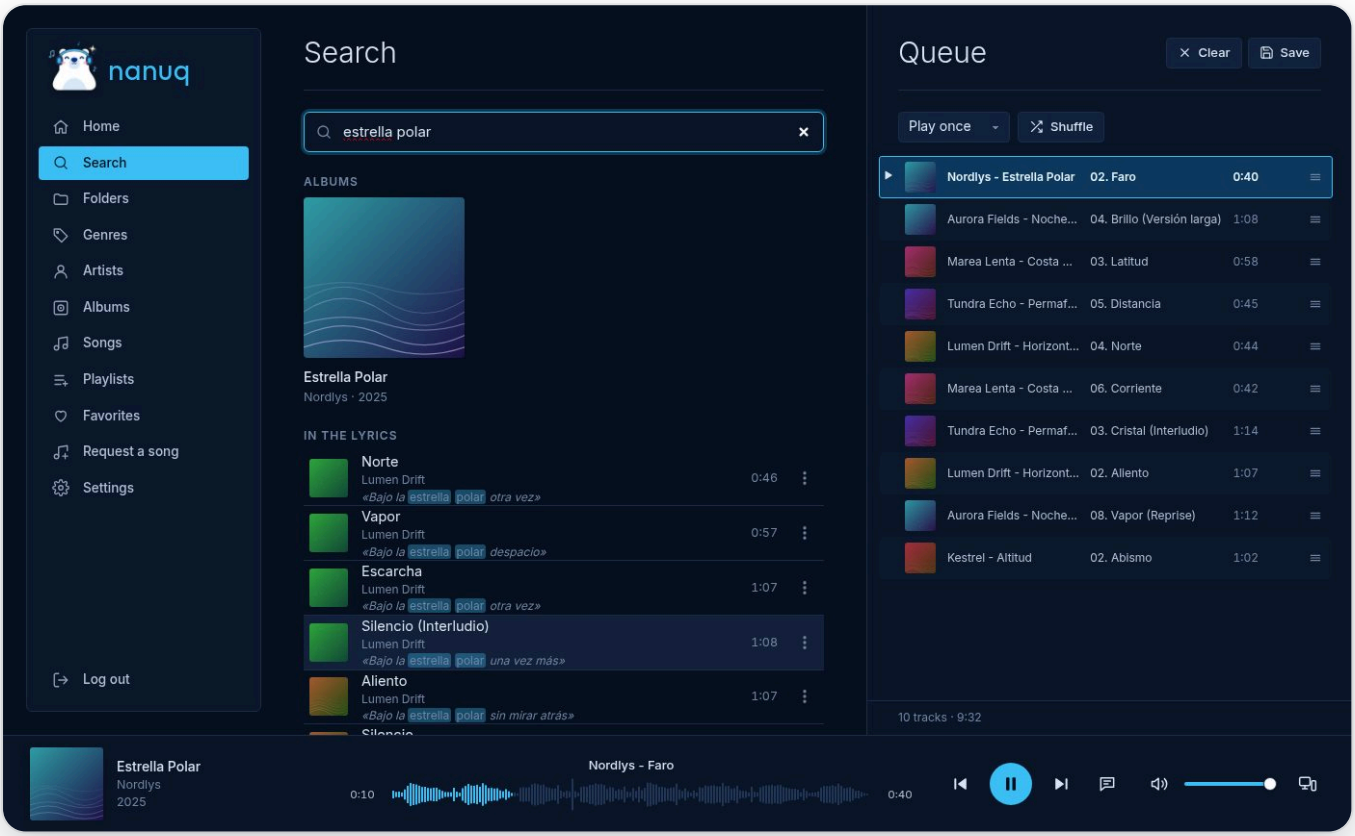
**Nanuq's tip**

To save lyrics in Jellyfin, your user needs the **Allow lyrics management** permission (Dashboard → Users). Without it, the lyrics are saved only on your device.

# 07 Search (also by lyrics)

Find a song even if you only remember a bit of the lyrics.






Searching “estrella polar”: albums and, below, “In the lyrics”.

Type at least 2 letters: artists, albums and songs show up. With 4 letters or more, **In the lyrics** also appears: songs whose lyrics contain what you typed, with the line highlighted (ignoring accents and capitals).



**Nanuq's tip**

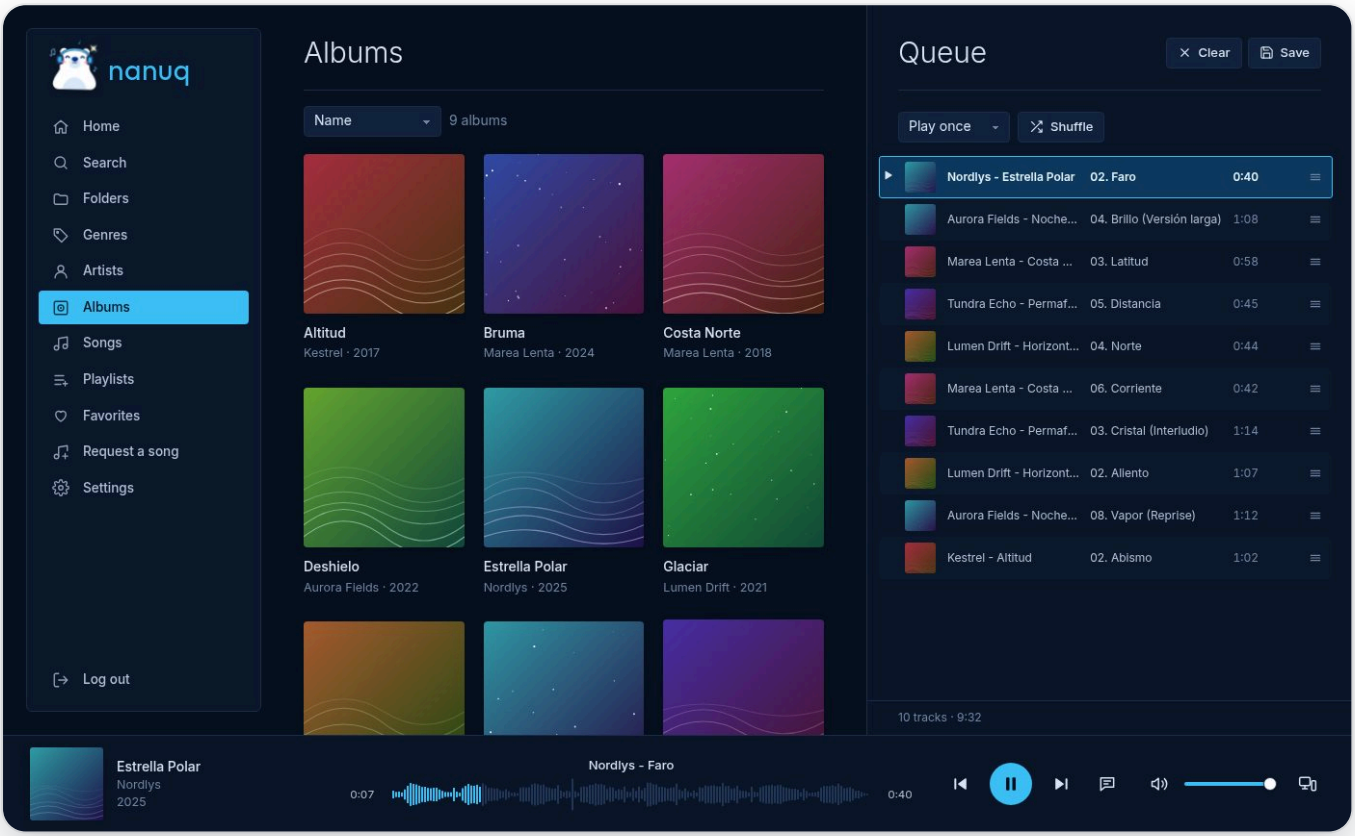
The first time, Nanuq reads your library's lyrics a few at a time (you'll see the progress) and builds its own encrypted index; afterwards it only adds new ones.

Songs can be shown as a list or a grid (buttons next to “Songs”).

# 08 Your library

Albums, artists, genres, playlists, favorites and folders.






Albums built from your songs' tags.

## Albums from your songs

Jellyfin builds albums by folder; Nanuq builds them from **each song's tags** (album and album artist). That way, a record split across two folders shows up together, "(Disc 2)" joins its record and duplicate songs show up only once.

## Everything else

- **Artists**: their songs (by album, A–Z or most played) and their albums, plus "Appears on".
- **Genres**, **Playlists** and **Folders** (how your server is organized).
- **Favorites**: everything you marked with ♥, sortable and always up to date with Jellyfin, even if you mark it from another app.

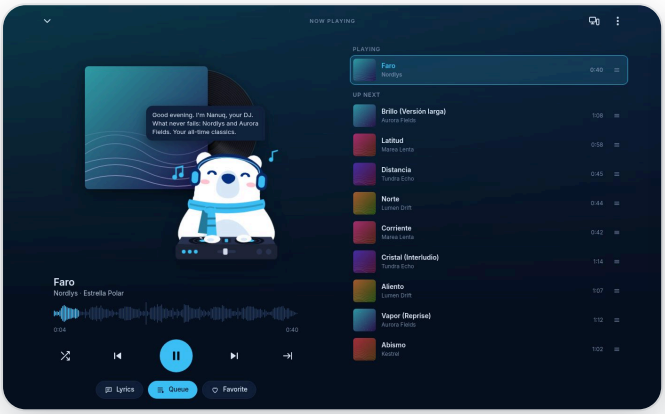


**Nanuq's tip**

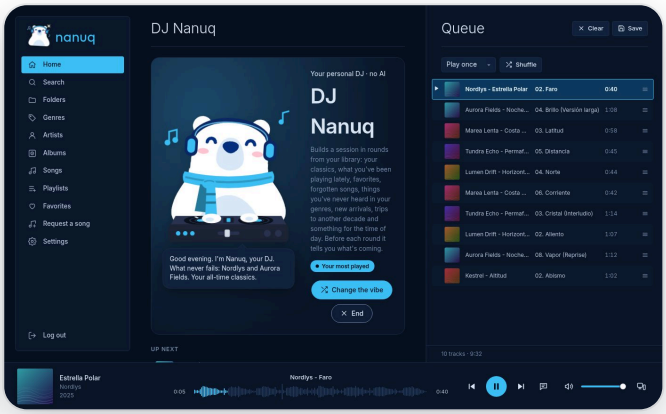
Changed tags or added music on the server? **Settings** → **Refresh from Jellyfin** asks for everything again (and, if you're an administrator, asks Jellyfin to scan your files).

# 09 DJ Nanuq

Your music presented like on the radio, without AI.




With the DJ, the cover spins like a record.




The DJ screen and what's next.

Tap the **DJ Nanuq** card on Home (or its ▶). Nanuq builds rounds of about 5 songs and introduces each one:

- **By genre** (Pop, Rock…) and **by decade** (the 80s, the 90s…), according to what's in your library.
- **To discover** (what you've never heard) and **forgotten** (more than 45 days without playing).
- Every now and then: something for the time of day, new arrivals and favorites.

**Change the vibe** jumps to another round; **End** turns the DJ off and keeps the queue. If you send the music to another device, the DJ session goes with it.



**Nanuq's tip**

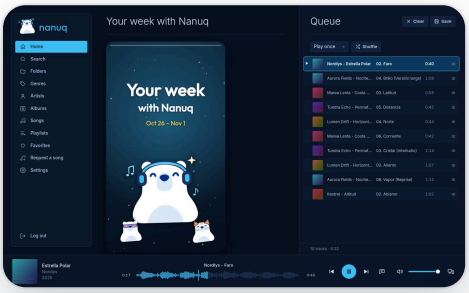
With a system voice installed (desktop), turn on **DJ voice**: Nanuq reads its introductions and lowers the music while it talks.

In **Settings** → **Player animations** you choose: Nanuq with its turntable, just the vinyl record or the usual cover.

# 10 Your week and Your year

What you listened to, in a video to share.






Your week with Nanuq.

**Settings → Your week with Nanuq → Create**: a video under a minute long about last week: minutes, days with music, your song of the week with a drumroll, your 5 most played, your artists' **podium**, your favorite hour, discoveries and the **music forecast**.

From **December 1st to 7th**, **Your year with Nanuq** shows up on Home, with your **music personality** (Nanuq dresses up according to your favorite genre).

**View** plays it; **Export video** records it as MP4 (on Android it lands in *Movies › Nanuq* and can be shared). Don't switch apps while it records.



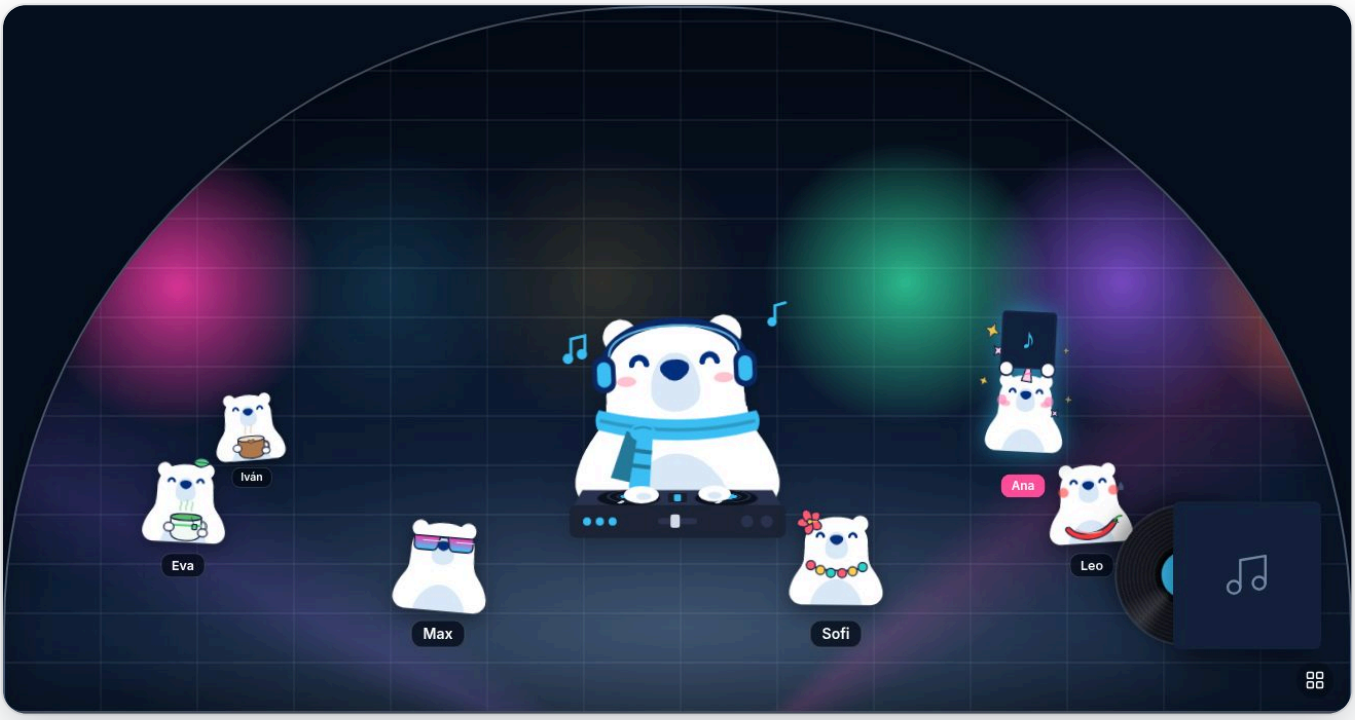
**Nanuq's tip**

With the **Playback Reporting** plugin in Jellyfin (and an administrator user) the data is exact; otherwise Jellyfin's basic data is used. Settings tells you which one.

# 11 Party

Your computer plays the music; your friends pick it from their phones.



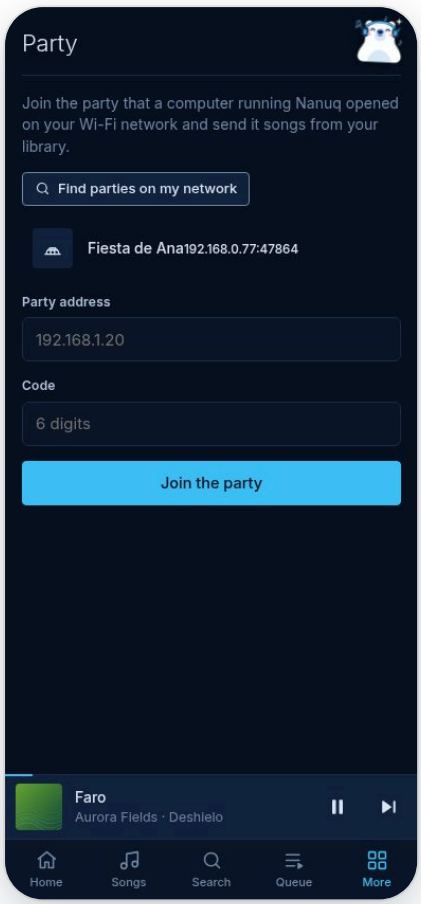



The igloo: DJ Nanuq in the center and a Nanuq for each guest.

## On the computer (host)

1. Sidebar → **Party** → **Open the party**. A **6-digit code** shows up.
2. While the room is open, the computer only shows the party and your music stops.
3. Put the igloo in **full screen** (great on a TV): **Up next** appears at the bottom; tap a song to play it now or drag it to change the order. The ↑ ↓ arrows change the volume.
4. **Close the party** removes everyone and deletes the received songs.

## On the phone (guest)




Find parties on your network.

1. Connect to the **same Wi-Fi network** as the computer.
2. More → **Party** → **Find parties on my network** (or type the address) and the code.
3. Search your playlists, artists, albums, songs or lyrics and tap a song to **send it**. Your phone downloads it from your Jellyfin and passes it to the computer, with its lyrics and cover.
4. Sing: the lyrics show up on your phone and on the igloo's ceiling.

Your Nanuq shows up in the igloo in your theme's costume, and when your song plays, it holds it up high. If your phone sleeps, you're still at the party and rejoin on your own. Only **Leave** takes you out.



**Heads-up**

If phones can't find the room, check the computer's firewall (TCP 47864 and UDP 47865) or type the address by hand.

# 12 My devices

One Nanuq plays; the others control it.



If you have Nanuq open on several devices with the same user, tap the **devices** icon in the player:

- **Send the music to…**: the queue continues there at the same second (DJ included).
- **Control…**: what plays there is handled from here, with its lyrics, queue and system controls.
- **Play here**: brings the music back.

If, when you open Nanuq, another of your devices is already playing on your network, it connects on its own. Settings → **My devices** has the switches (sync, only on the same network, accept commands from other users).



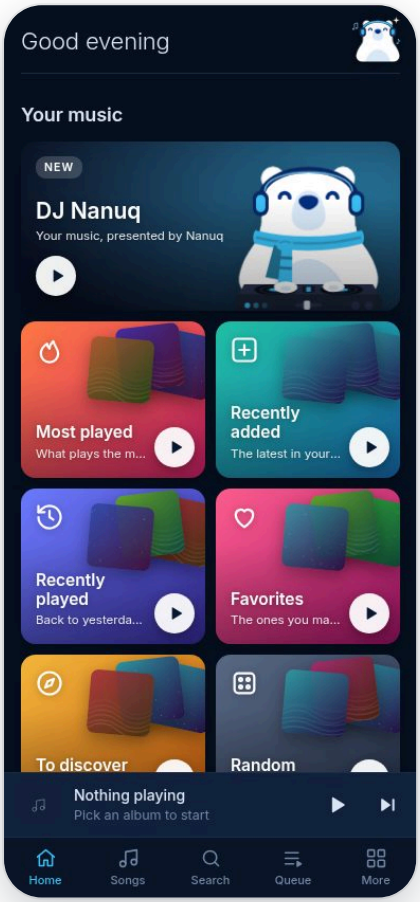
**Nanuq's tip**

Everything goes through your own Jellyfin: no ports are opened on your devices. For security, only your devices can play songs on yours.

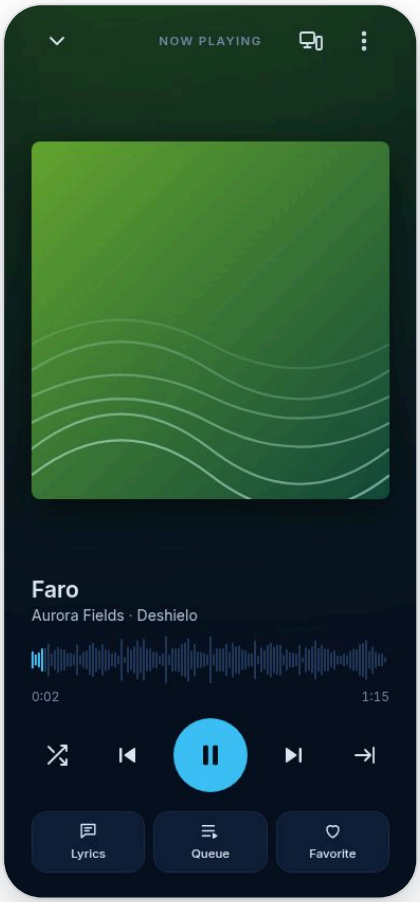
# 13 On the phone

Music in your pocket, with or without data.

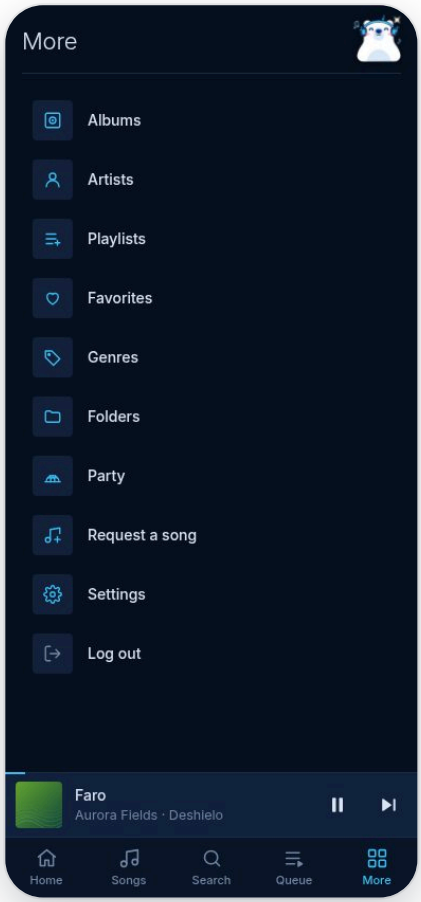





Home.




Player.




More.

- **Notification and lock screen** with cover and controls; Bluetooth headphones too. Unplugging the headphones pauses it.
- **Downloads**: tap **Download** in the player. Songs you play 3 times are saved automatically. In Settings → Downloads you choose the maximum, Wi-Fi only and the quality. Without a connection, Home takes you to your downloads.
- **What's next, saved ahead of time** (Settings → Playback): the phone downloads the next songs in your queue (10 minutes, adjustable) so a slow network goes unnoticed.
- **Back** closes dialogs; on Home, it sends the app to the background without stopping the music.



**Nanuq's tip**

Nanuq takes care of the battery: it only dances for a few seconds when each song starts and stops animating with the screen off.

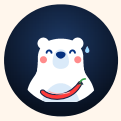
# 14 Request a song

Missing a song? Request it.



With **SomeDL** installed on your Jellyfin computer, Nanuq sends it your requests: SomeDL finds the song on YouTube Music, adds the cover, lyrics and details, and saves it in your library. Nanuq tells you when it's ready.

1. On the Jellyfin computer: `pipx install somedl`, set `output_dir` and `host = "0.0.0.0"`, and start it with `somedl web`.
2. In Nanuq: More → **Request a song** → type the address (for example `192.168.1.20`) → **Connect**.
3. Type `Artist - Song` or paste a YouTube link and tap **Request**.



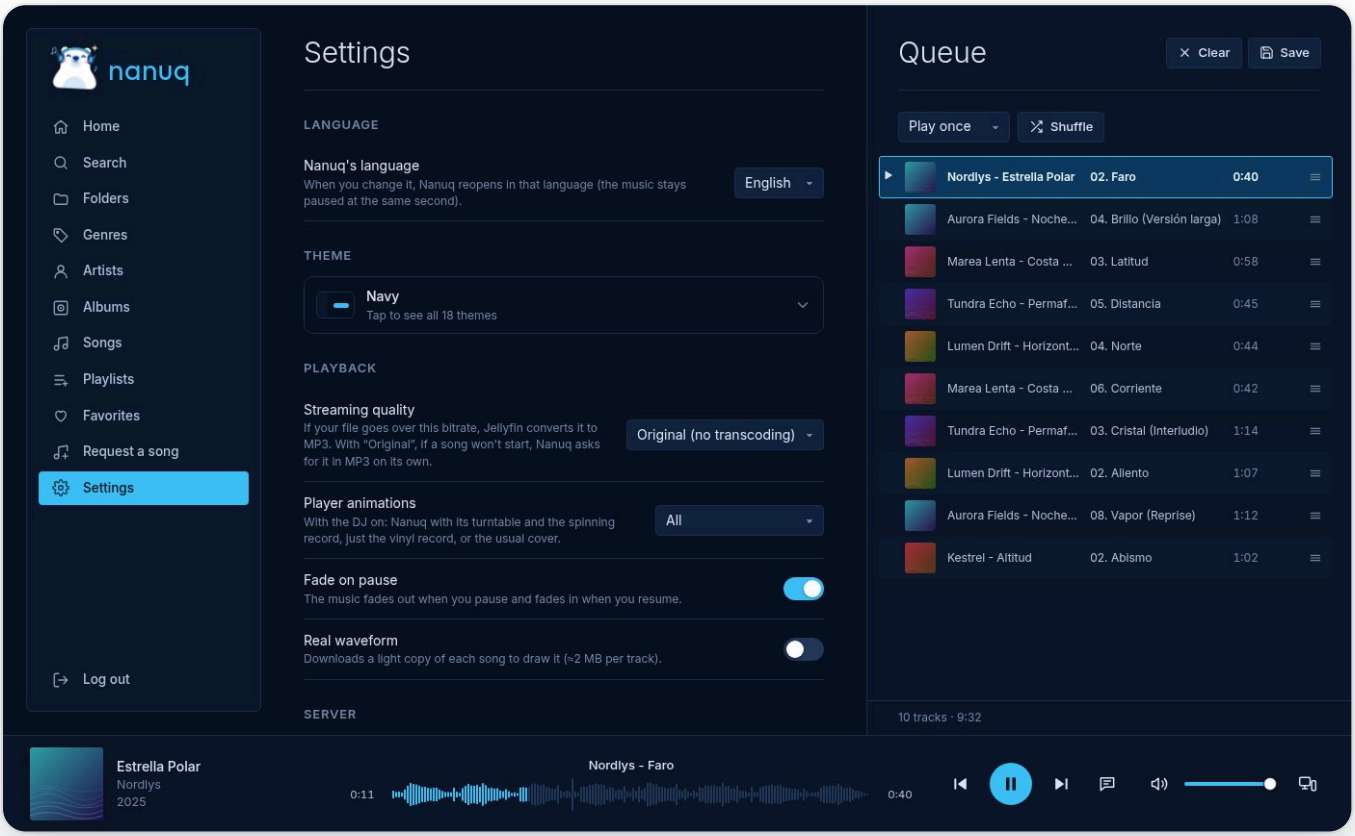
**Heads-up**

SomeDL has no password: use it only on your network or over a VPN.

# 15 Settings

Everything you can adjust, in one place.



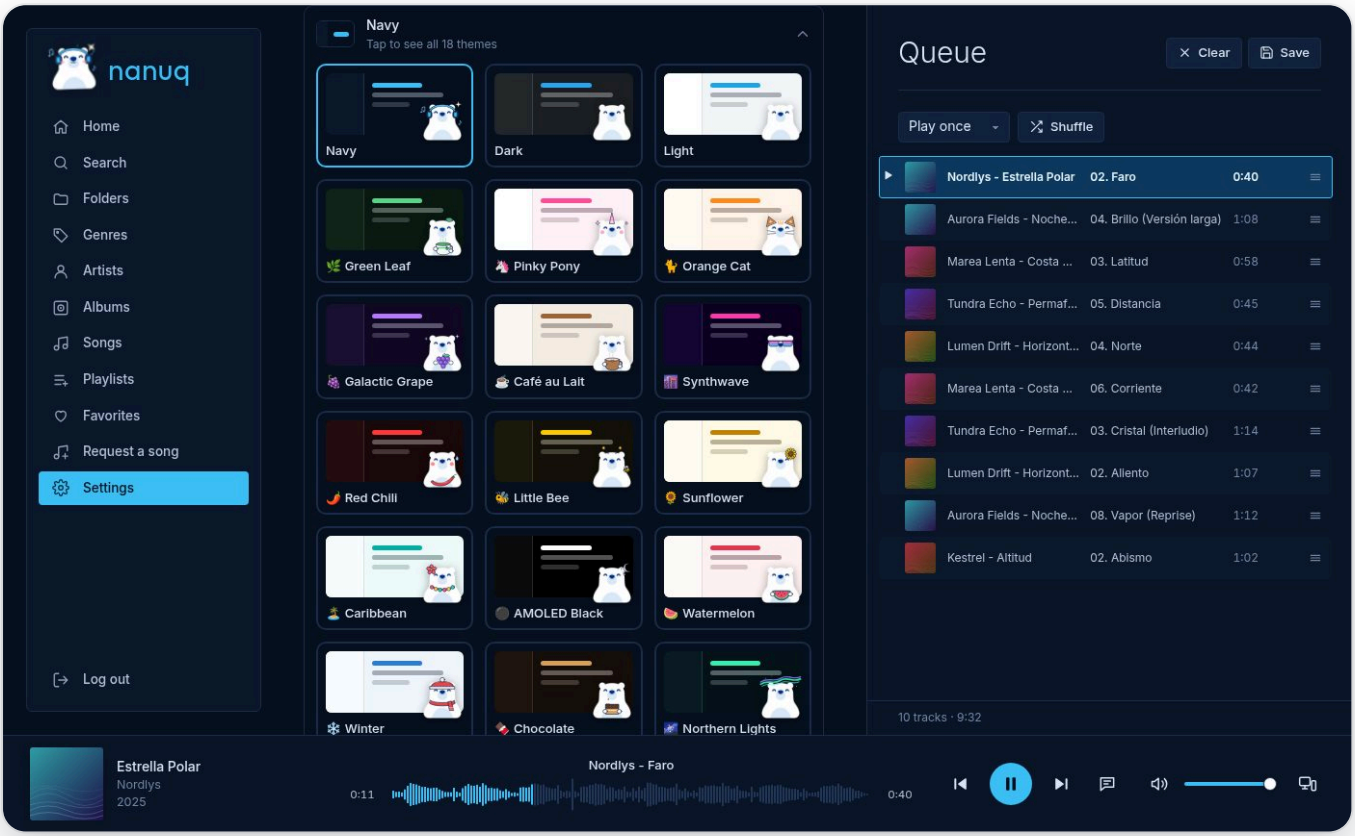



Settings on the computer.

| Setting | What it does |
|---|---|
| Language | Spanish, English or (Android) the system's. |
| Theme | 18 themes, each with its Nanuq. |
| Show on Discord | Desktop: “Listening to Nanuq” on your profile. If it doesn't show, the status line says why. |
| Streaming quality | Original or 320/192/128/96 kbps (MP3). |
| Save ahead of time | Android: how many minutes of the queue to download early. |
| Player animations | All, just the record or none. |
| Fade on pause | Smooth fade out and in. |
| Real waveform | Draws each song's waveform (uses some data). |
| Downloads | Android: maximum, Wi-Fi only, save the most played and quality. |

| Setting | What it does |
| --- | --- |
| My devices | Sync, same network only, commands from other users. |
| Server | Log out, Refresh from Jellyfin, Your week, saved data and Test connection. |




Settings → Theme: each theme with its Nanuq.

Each theme changes the app's colors **and** Nanuq's costume: headphones (Navy), unicorn horn (Pinky Pony), cat ears, grapes, coffee cup, neon glasses, chili, little bee, sunflower, flower necklace, moon, watermelon, winter hat, chocolate and auroras.


Marino
🌿 Green Leaf
🦄 Pinky Pony
🐈 Gato Naranjoso
🍇 Uva Galáctica
☕ Café con Leche
🌆 Synthwave
🌶️ Chile Rojo
🐝 Abejita
🌻 Girasol
🏝️ Caribe
⚫ Negro AMOLED
🍉 Sandía
❄️ Invierno
🍫 Chocolate
🌌 Aurora Boreal

# 17 Privacy and security

Your music, your data, your server.



- Nanuq only talks to **your** Jellyfin (and to SomeDL if you set it up). No accounts, no analytics, no ads. The only external thing is the Google Fonts fonts.
- Your session, your queue and anything that says something about you are stored **encrypted** (AES-256 with the system keyring or the Android keystore).
- Reviewed against malicious servers and metadata, memory and denial-of-service attacks.
- **Logging out** revokes your token and deletes personal data from the device.

## Free software

Nanuq is **free software** under the **GNU GPL version 3 or later**: you can use, study, share and modify it. If you share a modified version, it must carry the same license and its source code. It comes with no warranty. You can see it in **Settings** → **Nanuq** (at the bottom), with a link to the full text, and in the project's `LICENSE` file.



**Nanuq's tip**

The technical details are in `SECURITY.en.md` and in the technical manual.

# 18 Troubleshooting

When something doesn't go as expected.



| If this happens... | Try this |
|---|---|
| A song takes long to start | **Settings** → **Test connection**: it measures the server, the network and the player and tells you what fails. Try 320 kbps quality. |
| “Your session expired” | Log in again. If you use a proxy with its own login, log in to it. |
| I don't see my server changes | **Settings** → **Refresh from Jellyfin**. |
| Discord shows nothing | Look at the status line in Settings: it says whether it didn't find Discord, whether Windows didn't allow the connection (Discord as administrator) or whether Discord rejected it. |
| Phones can't see the party | Same Wi-Fi network, firewall (TCP 47864, UDP 47865) or type the address. |
| A favorite doesn't stick | Jellyfin 12 sometimes deletes it while it plays: Nanuq saves it again on its own. If it persists, mark it with the song paused. |
| “The encrypted store couldn't be opened” | Unlock the system keyring and open Nanuq again, or use **Start over**. |



**Nanuq's tip**

Anything else? Open an issue in the project. If it's a security problem, use GitHub's private reporting.

# Thanks for listening with Nanuq!

Now go: play your favorite song and let Nanuq dance.

